

Project Charter

Project Title

Enterprise Franchise Onboarding & Partner Portal Implementation

1. Project Overview

<u>Field</u>	<u>Details</u>
Project Name	Enterprise Franchise Onboarding & Partner Portal Implementation
Project Sponsor	Chief Executive Officer
Project Manager	Client Relations / Project Lead
Business Owner	Client Stakeholder / Merchant Leadership
Project Type	Strategic Client Expansion / Product Enhancement / Implementation
Project Duration	30 Days
Project Budget	\$50,000
Project Status	Approved / Completed

2. Executive Summary

The Enterprise Franchise Onboarding & Partner Portal Implementation project was initiated to support a strategic expansion opportunity with a large enterprise merchant seeking to onboard approximately 200 franchise locations. The client’s existing engagement only supported corporate locations, limiting account growth and preventing consolidated visibility across the broader franchise network.

To enable expansion, the organization committed to designing, building, testing, and demonstrating a centralized partner portal capable of supporting parent-child merchant structures, franchise onboarding workflows, and unified reporting. The project was delivered

within a 30-day timeline and required coordination across development, operations, sales, executive leadership, and client stakeholders.

Successful implementation would enable the client to manage both corporate and franchise locations through a single portal experience, secure approval for onboarding 200 additional franchise stores, and unlock approximately \$500K in annual recurring revenue while creating a scalable capability for future multi-location merchants.

3. Business Case / Justification

The client's current solution supported only corporate merchant locations and did not provide a centralized framework for managing franchise entities under a unified parent-child structure. As a result, the organization was unable to expand the client relationship to include approximately 200 franchise locations.

The client required a partner portal that would allow:

- Parent-child merchant account hierarchy management
- Consolidated visibility across corporate and franchise locations
- Franchise-specific onboarding workflow support
- Scalable administration through a single dashboard environment

Without this capability, the expansion opportunity would not proceed. The project therefore represented both a revenue-generating initiative and a strategic product enhancement opportunity.

Business Justification

Successful completion of the project would:

- Unlock approximately **\$500,000 in annual recurring revenue**
- Expand the existing client relationship from corporate-only coverage to franchise coverage
- Establish a differentiated partner portal capability not currently offered by competing providers
- Create a reusable framework for future multi-location and franchise merchants
- Improve operational support for more complex merchant onboarding structures

4. Project Objectives

The objective of this project is to design, build, test, and demonstrate a partner portal within 30 days that enables onboarding and management of franchise locations alongside existing corporate locations.

Specific Objectives

1. Develop a centralized partner portal capable of supporting parent-child merchant structures.
2. Enable onboarding workflows for approximately 200 franchise locations.
3. Provide unified visibility across corporate and franchise entities through a single dashboard.
4. Integrate the portal functionality with the existing client-facing platform where required for practical usability.
5. Achieve internal executive approval and external client acceptance of the solution.
6. Support commercial expansion of the client relationship by enabling rollout to franchise stores.

5. Project Scope

In Scope

- Development of a partner portal dashboard for multi-location merchant management
- Parent-child merchant hierarchy functionality
- Franchise onboarding workflow enhancements
- Visibility across both corporate and franchise merchant locations
- Portal testing and validation
- Executive review and demonstration preparation
- Client demonstration and acceptance process
- Readiness planning for onboarding approximately 200 franchise locations

Out of Scope

- Full redesign of the entire client portal platform
- Broad platform enhancements unrelated to franchise onboarding requirements
- Full standardization/redesign of all MID structures across the organization
- Additional merchant-facing features not required to support the franchise onboarding use case
- Long-term platform enhancements unrelated to the immediate rollout objective

6. Major Deliverables

The project will deliver the following outputs:

1. **Partner Portal Dashboard**
A centralized dashboard supporting enterprise and franchise location visibility.
2. **Parent-Child Merchant Hierarchy Functionality**
Functionality enabling both corporate and franchise locations to be managed within one structure.
3. **Franchise Onboarding Workflow Enhancement**
Updated onboarding functionality to support franchise MID structures and onboarding processes.
4. **Portal Testing & Validation Output**
Internal testing and operational validation confirming the portal supports onboarding and usability requirements.
5. **Executive Demo Package**
Demonstration environment and supporting materials for internal executive review and approval.
6. **Client Demonstration & Stakeholder Acceptance**
Final client-facing presentation and acceptance process supporting approval for franchise rollout.
7. **Rollout Readiness for 200 Franchise Locations**
Operational readiness to onboard approximately 200 franchise stores following stakeholder approval.

7. Timeline & Major Milestones

The project will be executed over a **30-day timeline** using a phased delivery approach.

<u>Phase</u>	<u>Timeline</u>	<u>Key Activities</u>	<u>Milestone</u>
Phase 1 – Requirements & Planning	Week 1	Confirm scope, budget, timeline, stakeholder roles, onboarding requirements, and development workstreams	Requirements approved and work breakdown aligned
Phase 2 – Design & Development	Week 2	Build partner portal functionality, parent-child structure support, and onboarding workflow enhancements	Core portal build completed

Phase 3 – Testing & Validation	Week 3	Test portal functionality, validate onboarding workflows, confirm corporate/franchise integration, resolve issues	Testing completed and portal validated
Phase 4 – Executive Review & Client Acceptance	Week 4	Conduct CEO demo, incorporate feedback, deliver final client demo, secure approval and rollout commitment	Executive approval and client acceptance achieved

Key Milestones

- **Project Kickoff / Requirements Alignment** – End of Week 1
- **Portal Build Complete** – End of Week 2
- **Testing & Validation Complete** – End of Week 3
- **Executive Approval** – Week 4
- **Client Acceptance / Rollout Approval** – End of Week 4

8. Budget

<u>Budget Category</u>	<u>Amount</u>
Development Budget	\$50,000
Total Approved Budget	\$50,000

Budget Notes

The approved budget supported development effort required to design and implement the partner portal capability within the one-month timeline. Internal stakeholder participation from operations, sales, client relations, and leadership was treated as part of normal business support rather than separately budgeted project cost.

9. Key Stakeholders

<u>Stakeholder</u>	<u>Role in Project</u>	<u>Level of Influence</u>
Client Stakeholder / Merchant Leadership	Primary external decision-maker and final acceptance stakeholder	High
CEO	Executive sponsor, strategic approver, internal decision-maker	High
Head Developer	Technical lead responsible for work breakdown and development execution	High
Development Team	Build and test portal functionality	Medium
Operations Team	Validate onboarding workflows, MID functionality, and operational usability	Medium
Sales Team	Support demo narrative, value messaging, and commercial positioning	Medium
Client Relations / Project Lead	Coordinate stakeholders, manage timeline, communication, and acceptance process	High

10. Project Manager Authority & Responsibilities

The Project Lead is responsible for coordinating the successful planning, execution, communication, and stakeholder alignment of the project.

Project Manager Responsibilities

- Own overall cross-functional coordination across development, operations, sales, leadership, client success, and client stakeholders
- Act as primary point of accountability for timeline management, communication, and stakeholder alignment
- Translate business and onboarding requirements into development tickets and feature requests
- Coordinate functionality requirements related to parent-child hierarchy, onboarding workflow changes, and reporting visibility

- Lead daily standups with development to monitor progress, surface blockers, and maintain alignment to delivery milestones
- Coordinate development and operations testing workstreams
- Provide progress updates to executive leadership and client stakeholders
- Partner with sales and leadership to prepare demonstration materials and stakeholder messaging
- Drive internal executive approval and external client acceptance of the solution

11. Risks, Assumptions, and Constraints

Risks

1. **First-Time Portal Development Risk**
The organization had not previously built a partner portal of this type, creating technical uncertainty and execution risk.
2. **Platform Integration Risk**
The new partner portal needed to function alongside existing client portal capabilities, introducing integration complexity and potential rework.
3. **Onboarding Workflow Compatibility Risk**
Franchise MID structures differed from current onboarding models, requiring custom workflow adaptation.
4. **Approval Risk**
Failure to align the portal demo with executive expectations could delay stakeholder approval and impact rollout readiness.
5. **Schedule Compression Risk**
The 30-day timeline left limited contingency for technical delays, testing issues, or rework.

Assumptions

- Development resources would remain available throughout the project timeline.
- Client requirements would remain stable enough to support delivery within 30 days.
- Operations would be available to validate onboarding workflows and test practical usability.
- Executive stakeholders would provide timely feedback during review and approval.
- Client stakeholders would participate in the final demo and acceptance process.

Constraints

- **Timeline:** 30-day implementation window
- **Budget:** \$50,000 approved development budget
- **Resource availability:** Dependent on cross-functional team capacity and development bandwidth
- **Technical limitations:** Need to work within the current platform environment rather than redesigning the broader portal infrastructure

12. Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful if the following outcomes are achieved:

1. A functioning partner portal is delivered that supports parent-child merchant structures.
2. Franchise onboarding workflow functionality is implemented and operationally validated.
3. Corporate and franchise locations can be managed through a unified portal experience.
4. Executive leadership approves the solution for client presentation.
5. The client accepts the solution and authorizes onboarding of approximately 200 franchise locations.
6. The initiative supports approximately **\$500K in annual recurring revenue opportunity**.
7. The resulting portal framework can be leveraged for future multi-location merchants.

13. Approval Requirements

Formal approval for project completion and rollout readiness requires:

- Internal executive approval of the partner portal solution
- Technical signoff that portal functionality is ready for use
- Operational validation of onboarding workflow feasibility
- Client stakeholder acceptance of the portal and onboarding approach

14. Approval / Signoff

<u>Name / Role</u>	<u>Approval Responsibility</u>	<u>Status</u>
CEO	Executive Sponsor Approval	Approved
Client Stakeholder / Merchant Leadership	Client Acceptance Approval	Approved
Head Developer	Technical Delivery Signoff	Approved
Operations Representative	Operational Validation Signoff	Approved
Client Relations / Project Lead	Project Completion Confirmation	Approved

15. Charter Approval Statement

This charter authorizes the Enterprise Franchise Onboarding & Partner Portal Implementation project and documents the business need, objectives, scope, budget, timeline, governance structure, and success criteria required to support successful execution and stakeholder acceptance.